

Zuni Dark-Sky Observing Plan

Backyard / Zuni Foothills: Winter Targets

Starfield 8SE telescope · New moon window · Jan 18, 2025

Target	Type	Best Time	Notes
Orion Nebula (M42)	Emission nebula	9 to 11 PM	Easy, show Kai first
Pleiades (M45)	Open cluster	Early eve	Wide field, low power
Andromeda (M31)	Skyline phone	After 8 PM	Setting west, catch early
Jupiter and moons	Planet	All night	Bands visible, steady air
Mars	Planet	10 PM on	Small disk, high power
Double Cluster	Open clusters	9 PM	NE, beautiful pair
Beehive (M44)	Open cluster	11 PM on	Rising east

Forecast: clear, 19F, wind light after 9. Red light only. Let scope cool 30 min. Thermos, two chairs, Copper stays in the truck if it drops below 15.